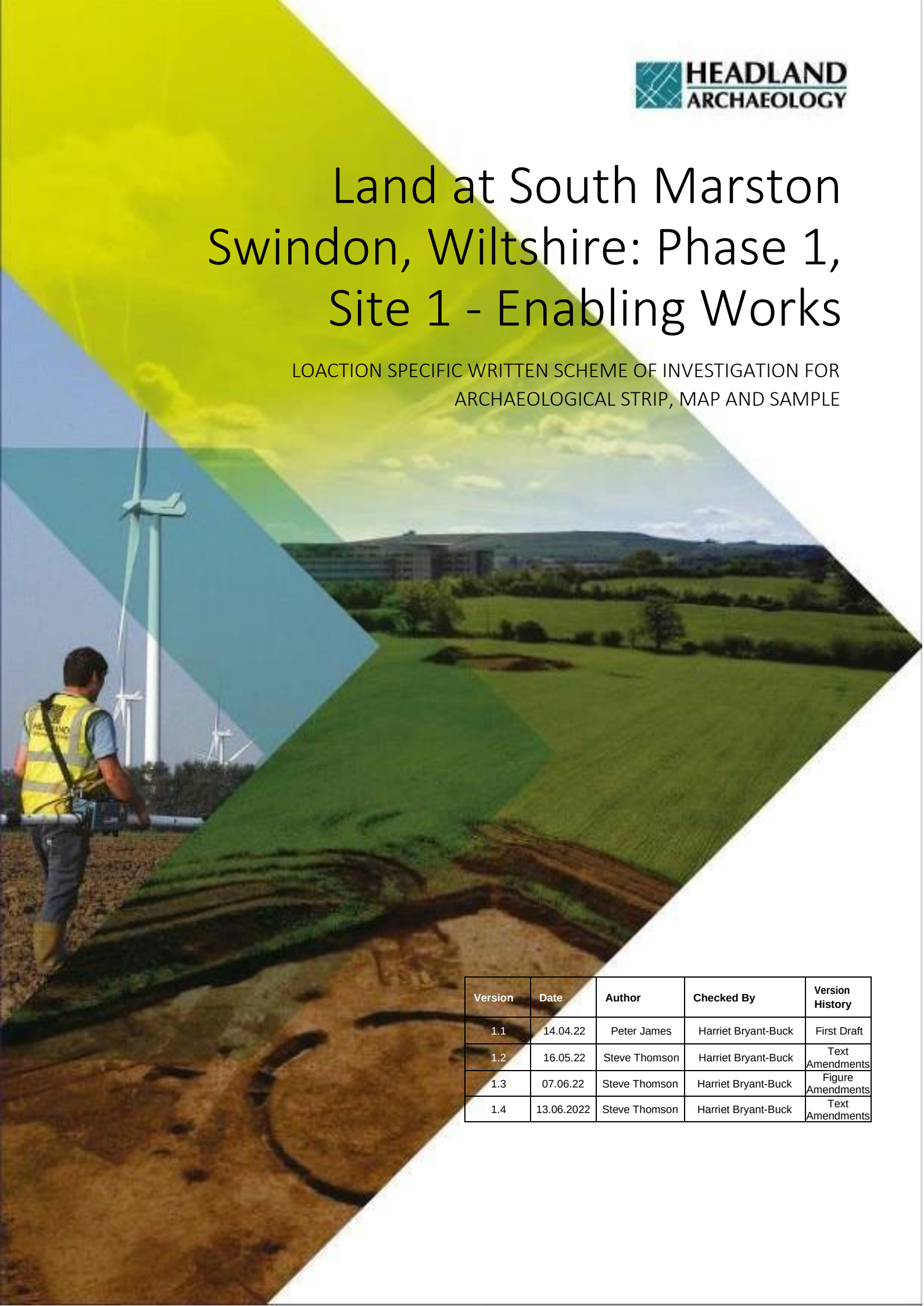
HEADLAND ARCHAEOLOGY

# Land at South Marston Swindon, Wiltshire: Phase 1, Site 1 - Enabling Works

LOACTION SPECIFIC WRITTEN SCHEME OF INVESTIGATION FOR ARCHAEOLOGICAL STRIP, MAP AND SAMPLE



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**CLIENT**
Orion Heritage Ltd
95 Ditchling Road,
Brighton
BN1 4ST

**HEADLAND ARCHAEOLOGY**
Headland Archaeology Ltd
Midlands & West
Unit 1
Clearview Court
Twyford Rd
Hereford,
HR2 6JR
www.headlandarchaeology.com

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|---|---|
| **PROJECT NAME** | Land at South of Marston (Site 1), Swindon, Wiltshire |
| **PLANNING REF** | S/OUT/13/1555 |
| **HEADLAND REF** | P22-122 |
| **NGR** | TL 63637 74072 |
| **WORK STAGE** | Location Specific Written Scheme of Investigation |
| **PURPOSE OF WORK** | To undertake a programme of Archaeological Strip, Map and Sample excavation as part of Phase 1 (enabling works) at Site 1. Mitigation will take place within a 15m-21m wide easement following the footprint of the haul road route (centre line of the primary street), compound footprint and the proposed location of Thornhill Road Roundabout.<br><br>The works aims to preserve the archaeological resource by record through establishing the presence, absence, location, extent, nature and date of any sub-surface archaeological features encountered. |
| **AUTHOR** | Peter James/ Steve Thomson |
| **PROJECT MANAGER** | Harriet Bryant-Buck |

# INTRODUCTION

Headland Archaeology (UK) Ltd (part of the RSK Group), was commissioned by Orion Heritage Ltd, appointed on behalf of Hallam Land Management, Taylor Wimpey & Hannick Homes Ltd ('The Consortium') to undertake an Archaeological Strip, Map and Sample excavation prior to the enabling works programme at Site 1 (centre at SU 19075 86930). The works are associated with the urban extension project located to the east of Swindon and north of the A420.

The enabling works at Site 1 comprise the haul road (centre line of the primary street), and compound footprint, including the area for the proposed Thornhill Roundabout (Figure 1).

The development requirement remains in accordance with Paragraph 194 of the National Planning Policy Framework (NPPF, MHCLG, 2021) which states:

> *In determining applications, local planning authorities should require an applicant to describe the significance of any heritage assets affected, including any contribution made by their setting. The level of detail should be proportionate to the assets' importance and no more than is sufficient to understand the potential impact of the proposal on their significance. As a minimum the relevant historic environment record should have been consulted and the heritage assets assessed using appropriate expertise where necessary. Where a site on which development is proposed includes, or has the potential to include, heritage assets with archaeological interest, local planning authorities should require developers to submit an appropriate desk-based assessment and, where necessary, a field evaluation.*

As a result, Orion Heritage Ltd were appointed to consult on behalf of the client to facilitate the programme of archaeological works in which comprises non-intrusive and intrusive archaeological investigation preceding the enabling and construction plans.

Headland Archaeology were appointed to undertake a programme of Strip, Map and Sample stated on the Outline Archaeological Mitigation Strategy (Orion Heritage 2017) and as part of Phase 1 of the Archaeological Mitigation Plan (Orion Heritage, Forthcoming). Additionally, as part of the works, Headland Archaeology were instructed to provide a Location Specific Written Scheme of Investigation (LS-WSI), outlining the standards and methodology for Phase 1 of the Archaeological Works for the enabling Works (Bourne 2022; 5.8).

The following document aims to define the scope of the work programme for Phase 1 at Site 1, in agreement with the LPA via Orion Heritage and in accordance with the requirements outlined in the statement above and with the Site-Wide Over-Arching Written Scheme of Investigation (Bourne 2022). No intrusive archaeological works will commence on the site until formal approval of the LS-WSI has been received.

## DESCRIPTION OF THE SITE

The proposed development site is located to the immediate east of Swindon, bounded by the A420 to the south, and the A419 to the west, covering a total of 165ha of agricultural land. The scheme also crosses carriageways, access routes and hedgerows.

Site 1 is located to the southern extent of South Marston Village, centred at SU 19075 86930. The archaeological works for Phase 1 comprise a total 3.3ha (21% sample of Site 1). The haul road route traverses through ten separate arable fields, enclosed by hedgerows and tree lines. It is bounded by Oxleaze Farm Community Woodland and further agricultural fields to the north, Old Vicarage Road to the east, Great Western Train Line to the south and Thornhill Road to the west. The proposed location for Thornhill roundabout, is positioned on the western extent of Site 1, consisting of a total area of 0.3ha.

The site is set on a gradual decline to the west, with an elevation of approximately 92m-102m aOD. The underlying bedrock comprise Ampthill Clay Formation and Kimmeridge Clay Formation (undifferentiated) – Mudstone and Down Sand Member - Sandstone, Ferruginous. Sedimentary

Bedrock formed approximately 152 to 164 million years ago in the Jurassic Period. Local environment previously dominated by shallow seas. (NERC 2022).

## ARCHAEOLOGICAL BACKGROUND

The archaeological background is covered in detail by the Site-Wide Overarching Written Scheme of Investigation (Bourne 2022). The following passage is a synthesis taken from that account, with specific focus on Site 1 and references to discussions from previous Archaeological Evaluations undertaken by Cotswold Archaeology (Brett 2015i & ii) and Foundation Archaeology (King 2015).

The results of the intrusive archaeological investigations identified substantial feature evidence of a settlement spanning from the middle Iron Age to early Romano-British periods. This comprise multi-ditched complexes forming boundaries, enclosures and associated trackways indicative of intensive agricultural activity. It is suggested that there is potential evidence for a 'ladder' settlement, with origins from the middle Iron Age.

There is also feature evidence associated with Medieval and post-Medieval agricultural practices. This landscape is represented by the base remains of plough furrows and potential stockades or livestock corals likely associated with recorded Medieval settlement at the present location of South Marston Farm (SU18NE461).

Evidence pre-dating the Iron age was limited at Site 1, with only a single piece of flint recovered from subsoil deposits to the north of South Marston Farm (Brett 2015i) and sherds of early prehistoric pottery (potential Bronze Age) retained from sealed contexts ascribed to the Roman period. It's plausible this dating evidence suggests that occupation of the site may have begun in the earlier prehistoric period (King 2015). These trenches excavated by Foundations Archaeology were positioned in the western part of Site 1, located in the footprint of Thornhill roundabout.

Within the broader context of the site, feature evidence was investigated at Site 7 (located to the north-east). These features consist of three concentric 'ring' ditches tentatively interpreted as ploughed out barrows of early Bronze Age date (Brett 2015ii). Two notable finds spots were recorded in close proximity, a Mesolithic flint knapping site (WHER SU18NE051) located c.800m to the south-west and a Neolithic polished stone axe was recorded c.300m to the south (WHER SU18NE105). So it is plausible to suggest the site potentially resides either in-between areas of occupied land use during the prehistoric period or the Iron Age/Romano-British settlement truncates earlier prehistoric evidence.

## OBJECTIVES

The primary archaeological objectives are to characterise the buried remains and determine the character, extent, date, integrity, state of preservation and quality of the resource and preserve them by record.

In addition, the aims are to investigate and contribute towards the following research objectives. (set out by South-West Archaeological Research Framework (SWARF; Grove and Croft 2012). The following account is an extract taken from the Site-Wide Over-Arching Written Scheme of Investigation (Bourne 2022);

- *Theme A: Settlement Sites and Landscapes – Urban, Rural, Maritime and Prehistoric*
- *Theme B: Artefacts and the Built Environment – Technologies, Resources, Links to Trade*
- *Theme D: Social Identity and Change – Transition, Identity, Territories, Religion, Conflict and Death*
- *Theme E: Economies and Subsistence – Trade, Agriculture, Transport and Communication*

*The general research aims of the proposed mitigation work are:*

- *To establish the extent and character of the Iron Age activity to the north and north-east of Rowborough Farm and the 'ladder' settlement to the west of Manor Farm. The investigations will consider the archaeological interest of these remains in the context of the regional archaeological framework.*

- *To establish the extent and character of the late Iron Age and Roman settlement and related activity in the area of Manor Farm and the nature of the possible boundary ditches to the east and west of Rowborough Farm. The investigations should consider the archaeological interest of these remains in the context of the regional archaeological framework.*

- *To establish the extent and character of the Late Neolithic/early Bronze Age activity to the north, north-west and north-east of Rowborough Farm and to consider the archaeological interest of these remains in the context of the regional archaeological framework.*

- *To examine any available evidence for economic activity and environmental conditions for all archaeological periods.*

- *To generate an archive which will allow future research of the evidence to be undertaken if appropriate.*

- *To disseminate the results of the work in a format and manner proportionate to the significance of the findings.*

**SCHEDULE**

Subject to receipt of the necessary approval from the Local Planning Archaeologist (LPA), the programme of Strip, Map and Sample will commence 16th May 2022 (TBC) with the fieldwork to be carried out over a 12 week period, with an allowance for additional time if required.

**PROJECT TEAM**

The project will be managed for Headland Archaeology by Harriet Bryant-Buck (Project Manager); the field team will consist of suitably qualified archaeologists. *Curricula vitae* of key personnel can be supplied on request. The project team will familiarise themselves with the background to the site and will be aware of the project's aims and methodologies.

The post-excavation advisor for the project will be Alex Smith (Headland Post-excavation Manager). Specialist artefact analyses will be managed by Julie Franklin (Headland Finds, Archiving and Publications Manager). Julie will undertake finds assessment within her areas of expertise (medieval and post-medieval metalwork, glassware, clay pipes, ceramic building material and other small finds). Further consultation will be sub-contracted to recognised period specialists familiar with finds from this geographical area (table 1). These may be differ at time of assessment, though updates will be provided if required.

Table 1: Headland Archaeology Finds Specialists

| Material | Prehistoric | Roman | Medieval (AS to early PM) | Modern |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Pottery | Owain Scholma Mason | Sara Machin | Paul Blinkhorn | Julie Franklin |
| CBM | Sara Machin | Sara Machin | Paul Blinkhorn | Julie Franklin |
| Lithics | Rebecca Devaney | - | - | - |
| Coarse Stone | Julie Franklin | Julie Franklin | Julie Franklin | Julie Franklin |
| Metalwork | Julie Franklin | Julie Franklin | Julie Franklin | Julie Franklin |

| | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Clay Pipe | - | - | Julie Franklin | Julie Franklin |
| Glass | Hilary Cool | Hilary Cool | Rachel Tyson | Julie Franklin |
| Arch Frags | - | TBC | Mark Samuel | Mark Samuel |
| Misc Finds | Julie Franklin | Julie Franklin | Julie Franklin | Julie Franklin |
| Industrial Waste | Rod McKenzie | Rod McKenzie | Rod McKenzie | Rod McKenzie |
| Conservation | Pieta Greaves, Drakon Heritage | Pieta Greaves, Drakon Heritage | Pieta Greaves, Drakon Heritage | Pieta Greaves, Drakon Heritage |

Headland has in-house specialists who can undertake analysis of plant remains, with Dr. Michael Wallace, Kate Turner, Kath Hunter Dowse and Laura Bailey on the team. Laura Bailey also works on charcoal and animal remains. Human remains will be assessed by Suzanne McGalliard.

Headland Archaeology (UK) Ltd is a Registered Archaeological Organisation and abides by the Codes of Conduct and Approved Practice and Standards of the Chartered Institute for Archaeologists. The company has all the necessary technical and personnel resources for the satisfactory completion of the fieldwork programme.

## INSURANCE & COPYRIGHT

Headland Archaeology (UK) Ltd is fully indemnified and all necessary insurances can be presented on request.

Copyright will be retained by Headland Archaeology (UK) Ltd. Headland will license the client, and other bodies as necessary for use in matters relating to the project and for use of the project archive by the relevant museum. This license will also extend to non-commercial use.

## HEALTH & SAFETY

All work undertaken by Headland Archaeology is carried out in accordance with current H&S legislation. A risk assessment and method statement will be prepared prior to the commencement of fieldwork. All staff will wear appropriate PPE and this will include high-visibility clothing, hard hats and safety footwear as a minimum. Suitable site welfare facilities will be located at an appropriate and accessible location after consultation and agreement with the client.

## ACCESS

This LS-WSI is submitted on the understanding that there will be unhindered access to all relevant areas of the site. This will be arranged prior to commencement of works.

## ARCHAEOLOGICAL STRATEGY

The results of the previous intrusive archaeological works (Cotswold Archaeology 2015i & ii; Foundations Archaeology 2015) determined that the haul road route (in line with the proposed primary street) dissects through a complex of buried feature evidence indicative of Iron Age and Romano-British Settlement activity, with potential un-recorded remains (pits, structures) and associated infrastructure (roads, trackways, stockade enclosures). There is also evidence of Medieval and Post-Medieval land management, likely connected with the recorded Medieval settlement located at South Marston farm (SU18NE461). There appears to be low potential for previous unrecorded prehistoric remains, with the documented evidence limited to residual artefacts. However, it is possible that Iron Age/Romano-British archaeology could disturb earlier evidence which may become apparent during the works.

The Phase 1 programme of Archaeological works comprise of the following as outlined in the Site-Wide Over-Arching Written Scheme of Investigation (Bourne 2022);

*Thornhill Roundabout*

*The area of the roundabout, adjacent balancing pond and associated construction compound…will be subject to an initial phase of geophysical survey followed by a strip, map and sample excavation of the construction zone.*

*Haul Road*

*The haul road follows the same route as the primary street. A c.21m wide corridor centred on the line of the primary street will be subject to full archaeological excavation and recording ahead of construction commencing. The remainder of this area is open space in the masterplan which will be delivered as part of Phase 4. For the enabling works, this area will be fenced off and no construction works or planting will occur within the open space is implemented in later phases of the construction of the scheme*

## FIELDWORK METHOD

Topsoil and subsoil will be removed by mechanical excavator using a bladed bucket. All overburden removal will take place under continuous archaeological supervision.

This will be carried within the Phase 1 enabling works design areas. The storage location of spoil will be agreed prior to the commencement of the fieldwork and the standard of storage of excavated materials will be formally agreed.

Where archaeological features are identified, these will be marked on the ground by spray paint or survey flags and a pre-excavation survey plan will be carried out at the earliest opportunity using dGPS. These plans will be used as the basis for the excavation strategy.

A programme of hand investigation, sample excavation and subsequent data collection of the archaeological resource will be carried out, in accordance with CiFA standards and guidance.

Headland Archaeology will liaise with Orion Heritage, to ensure the required cover for construction areas and associated infrastructure is in place.

A sample excavation strategy will be agreed by Orion Heritage and LPA, based upon the potential and the integrity of the resource (under the pretence that the areas outside of the Phase 1 work programme will be mitigated under Phase 4).

## PROGRAMME OF SITE WORKS

The Strip, Map and Sample excavation will use the following sequence of works.

### Mechanical excavation and soil storage

- A 20-30 tonne tracked excavator will be used to remove the topsoil and subsoil horizons exposing the archaeological level within the designated work areas.
- The excavator will be fitted with a toothless grading bucket and monitored under archaeological supervision.
- Topsoil and subsoil will be separated and loaded into dumper trucks.
- The dumper(s) will track on designated haul routes, with the top and subsoil material stored separately and within designated stockpile areas.
- These stockpiles will be sealed and managed by the Civil Engineering contractor.
- All spoil removal and handling will be in line with the spoil management plan detailed in the Construction Phase Plan for archaeological works

As far as reasonably practicable topsoil shall be handled when dry and friable in consistency. However, there will be occasions where programme constraints require handling when moist and plastic. In addition, there may be areas where the soils may never be in a dry and friable condition

(e.g. in low lying areas prone to pooling of water or seasonal flooding).

During adverse weather conditions, mechanical excavation will cease and an assessment will be made whether the ground conditions is viable for spoil to be removed and stored within compliance of the client specification and the spoil management plan.

No plant will be permitted to track onto archaeologically exposed areas until they have been investigated sufficiently and formally approved by LPA via Orion Heritage.

**Hand Investigation**

A representative sample of exposed features will be investigated. This sample excavation will be based upon the function, character and suitability of intrusive investigation during the Phase 1 archaeological works.

If features are in excess of 1m deep, stepping will be put in place in line with the method statement policy. If this is impractical or unsafe, a request may be made to allow excavation of these features by machine, though this will be on a case-by-case basis.

**Linear features**

Where linear features are encountered a suitable sample (generally a minimum 10% sample of the exposed length) will be excavated to characterise the feature. Interventions will be at least 1m in width. Intervals between will be decided on-site and will be determined with reference to the what the function/characteristics of the feature would represent i.e. settlement, industrial, agricultural or structural function. A suitable sample will be excavated away from intersections with other features in order to minimise contamination and maximise feature sample representation.

An increased sample will be excavated through linear features associated with direct occupation, industrial structures or other specific activity; sufficient to understand the historical development of the site. Where the analysis of data indicates that significant further artefactual or ecofactual remains can be recovered, a further sample will be excavated in agreement following consultation with LPA via Orion Heritage.

**Discrete features**

With the exception of modern pits, all pits or spreads measuring up to 2m in diameter will be half sectioned as minimum (minimum 50% sampled). Those larger than this may be excavated to a minimum 25% sample or investigated via test pits to characterise their nature, purpose and date, where safe to do so. Where possible, all initial excavation will be located away from intersections with other features to minimise contaminated samples.

Post-holes will be initially half sectioned as a minimum (50%). If pits or post-holes are determined to be related to structures; where initial data collection indicates that further artefactual or ecofactual materials can be recovered; these features will be fully excavated (100%).

The above sampling percentages represent minimum requirements and appropriate strategies will be applied dependent on the nature of remains identified.

Natural features such as tree throws will be test excavated to characterise and confirm their nature.

**Complex features (Intersections between feature types, confluence of linear features, intercutting pits)**

The excavation of all relationships between archaeological features will be undertaken with the understanding that the integrity of the resource will not be jeopardised. The mitigation will aim to investigate the relationship between exposed features or deposits, where safe to do so, to elucidate the stratigraphy of the site.

**Human remains:**

All finds of human remains will be reported to the client, the consultant and the local planning archaeologist. A license for the excavation of human remains will be applied for from the Ministry of Justice prior to excavation.

If human remains are identified during archaeological works, they will be excavated in their entirety (100%) by a suitably competent archaeologist, with input from the Headland Archaeology environmental team and an osteological specialist if required. Urned cremations will be block lifted if possible to be excavated off-site. All excavation and treatment of cremated and inhumed human remains will be undertaken recognising the CIfA Technical Paper Number 13 (Brickley & McKinley & 2004).

**Additional features:**

Structural remains such as penannular ditches, walls, short segments of ditches or post-holes that are demonstrated as components of buildings, will be sufficiently excavated to understand, where possible, the construction and use of the building. If partial remains are exposed within the Phase 1 Strip, Map and Sample excavation, consultation with LPA via Orion Heritage will be made and an agreed strategy in place how best to proceed. This will be initiated as soon as the evidence is presented.

Feature type sample size summary table

| ***Feature type*** | ***Feature example*** | ***Minimum sample percentage*** |
|---|---|---|
| Linear features (non-structural) | Field boundaries, enclosure ditches | 10% |
| Structural features | Walls, post hole groups | 100% |
| Discrete features <2m | Pits, isolated post holes | 50% |
| Discrete features >2m | Quarry pits, spreads | 25% |
| Intersections | Relationships between features | 100% |
| Human remains | Inhumations and cremations | 100% |

**Metal detecting**
Metal detecting will be undertaken on spoil bunds and stripped areas to recover material. This will increase finds recovery and assist in the understanding and interpretation of the site.

Metal detecting will also be carried out over archaeological features to enhance finds recovery during hand excavation work.

**RECORDING**

All recording will follow *CIfA Standards and Guidance for Archaeological Excavations* (CIfA 2014; 3.3).

> *Full and proper records (written, graphic, electronic, digital and photographic as appropriate) should be made for all work, using pro forma record forms and sheets as applicable. Digital records created as part of the project should comply with specified data standards. Digital information, paper and photographic records must be stored in a secure and appropriate environment and be regularly copied or backed up, and copies stored in a separate location.*

A fully cross-referenced archive will be compiled in accordance with the guidelines of Historic England's procedural document, Management of Research Projects in the Historical Environment (MoRPHE) (HE 2015).

Each context will be recorded on a pro-forma context sheet by written and measured description.

Digital photographs (high resolution TIFF (uncompressed) images) will be taken as appropriate, to record each feature, the site, and landscape context. Photographic records will include an appropriate scale measure.
A site plan including all identified features, areas of excavation and other pertinent information will be recorded digitally. The site plan will be accurately linked to the National Grid and heights to OD. Where appropriate, sections and stratigraphic sequences will be recorded digitally. Digital recording

will be undertaken using a differential GPS. If additional detailed recording of features and sections is required (i.e. where their complexity means that archaeological information could be lost if recorded digitally) then plans and sections will be hand-drawn on permatrace at an appropriate scale (generally 1:20 or 1:10 for plans and 1:10 for sections).

Headland maintains a digitally based library of guidance documents that includes information on excavation and recording. Relevant parts can be forwarded on request. Finds will be routinely recorded by context and recorded 3-dimensionally where appropriate (i.e. where their position within a context can provide further significant information or the find is of particular significance). Any artefacts retrieved during the evaluation will be cleaned using appropriate techniques and packaged and stored in accordance with First Aid for Finds (Watkinson & Neal, 1998).

**Soil Samples, Artefacts and Eco-facts**

All artefacts recovered during the excavation will be cleaned, catalogued, and analysed with reference to the regional artefactual type series. Headland Archaeology Finds Department will be available to provide advice remotely or on site if necessary and provide spot dates on request.

All finds will be cleaned, catalogued and prepared for storage in accordance with the guidelines contained in CIfA (2014c), Walker (1990) and Watkinson and Neal (2001).

Significant findings will be given priority, and reported to LPA via Orion Heritage. All artefactual and ecofactual material recovered during the excavation will be retained for recording and subsequent assessment and, where appropriate, further analysis. They will be treated in accordance with the CIfA Guidelines for the collection, documentation, conservation and research of archaeological material (2008).

The terms of the Treasure Act 1996 will be followed with regards to any finds which might fall within its scope. Any finds of this nature will be removed to a safe place and reported only to the Local Finds Liaison Officer, where the appropriate information will be forwarded to the Coroner as required by the procedures laid down in the “Code of Practice”. Where removal cannot be effected on the same working day as the discovery, suitable security measures will be taken to protect the finds from theft.

Deposits identified as archaeologically significant will be sampled for environmental remains and other finds (e.g. pottery, CBM etc.). Sampling will be undertaken in line with current Historic England (Campbell et al 2011) and Headland Archaeology guidelines. Bulk samples will be taken from well-sealed or dateable deposits for wet sieving and floatation. A bulk sample will typically be 40 litres or 100% of smaller contexts. Larger samples may be taken if deposits of significant interest are encountered. . Samples taken on site will be processed and assessed with the results and recommendations for any further work included in the evaluation report.

Where waterlogged deposits are encountered (such as peat) appropriate sampling techniques will be employed so as to maximise the environmental information gained from such deposits. This may include the taking of monolith or core samples for pollen and non-pollen palynomorphs (e.g. testates and fungal spores) and bulk specialist samples of 20 litres, or 100% of the deposit, for plant macrofossil insect analyses. If waterlogged wood is encountered sampling should be undertaken following Historic England guidelines (Brunning *et al.* 2010) and under consultation with a wood specialist where appropriate.

If intact surfaces such as buried soils or occupation layers are encountered, samples for soil micromorphology should be considered.

**Monitoring**

Access to the site will be afforded to the LPA for monitoring and a weekly archaeological progress report will be provided.

**REPORTING AND ARCHIVE**

The reporting of the Archaeological Investigations will be undertaken in phases as stated in the

Site-Wide Over-Arching Written Scheme of Investigation (Bourne 2022).

On completion of Phase 1; Strip, Map and Sample excavation an interim report will be produced summarising the results.

This will include the following;

- General description of the site stratigraphy,
- Provisional dating of finds
- General plans and sections of the site and of key features within it,
- Details of short-term archiving arrangements and subsequent post-excavation works

One copy of this report will be provided to Orion Heritage for onward submission to the LPA.

**Post-Excavation Assessment**

Following from the interim report, Headland Archaeology will carry out an assessment of the results and produce a 'Post-excavation Assessment Report' within six months of the completed archaeological fieldwork for that phase, unless otherwise agreed in writing with the LPA.

In accordance with the Site-Wide Over Arching Written Scheme of Investigation (Bourne 2022) the report will meet the following criteria;

*The Post Excavation Assessment Report is to include as a minimum:*

- *An Abstract summarising the scope and results of the archaeological investigation.*
- *An Introduction including:*
    - *the location of the site including a National Grid Reference for the centre sufficient to locate the site to 1m accuracy;*
    - *an account of the background and circumstances of the work;*
    - *a description of the development proposals, planning history and planning reference together with the planning condition (where appropriate);*
    - *the nature of potential impacts arising from the proposals;*
    - *the scope and date of the fieldwork, the personnel involved and who commissioned it;*
- *An account of the archaeological background of the development site including:*
    - *geology, soils and topography;*
    - *any known existing disturbances on the site;*
    - *the background archaeological potential of the site. This will include a summary of the known Historic Environment Record entries within 500m of the boundaries of the site (or wider where appropriate). The HER entries should be quoted with their full KHER identifier (e.g. TR 34 NW 16);*
    - *a summary of any previous phases of archaeological investigation at the development site; any constraints on the archaeological investigation.*
- *The methodology employed during the investigation. Specified aims and objectives will be*

*included, as will any additional objectives identified during the course of the investigation.*

- *The report will include a quantification of the archive contents, their state and future location.*

- *A description of the results of the archaeological investigation. This description will include:*

  - *the nature and depth of overburden soils encountered;*

  - *a description of the geological subsoil encountered across the site;*
  - *description of all archaeological features and finds encountered, their dimensions, states of preservation and interpretation;*

  - *heights related to Ordnance Datum will be provided for each feature and deposit;*

  - *for complex remains a Harris Matrix diagram may be provided.*

*The finds recovered during the course of the investigation will be described, quantified and assessed by artefact type within the report. The report will also indicate the potential of each category of artefact for further analysis and research. For each category of artefact, the report will describe the method of processing, any sub-sampling, conservation and assessment undertaken. Where appropriate, local reference collections will be referred to for descriptive and analytical consistency. Any implications for future archive, conservation or discard of the artefacts will also be detailed. Consideration will be given to specialist examination of key finds, such as x-ray analysis of objects in accordance with current guidance (EH 2006).*

*The report will include a table showing the contexts, classes and quantity of artefacts recovered, together with their date and interpretation.*

*The report will include an assessment of the environmental potential of the site. Details will be provided of any environmental sampling undertaken in connection with the fieldwork and the results of any processing and assessment of the samples. The report will describe the method of processing, any sub-sampling and assessment. Any potential for future analysis of the samples or environmental remains recovered from the investigation will be described. Implications for future archive, conservation or discard of environmental samples or remains will be detailed.*

*The report will include, as appropriate, tables summarising environmental samples taken, together with the results of processing and assessment. Any results from the application of archaeological scientific techniques e.g. specialist dating will be included in the assessment report.*

*The assessment report will also include an interpretation of the archaeology of the site. This will be a synthesis of the stratigraphic, finds and environmental results of the investigation and a consideration of the site in its wider context as appropriate. This section will be supported by a phased interpretative plan of the site, clearly showing the major areas and periods of archaeological activity.*

*The report will also include an assessment of the results of the archaeological investigations and their potential to address both the original research aims and objectives of the project and any further research objectives identified during the course of the on-site and post excavation works.*

*The report will include a detailed proposal for any further analysis necessary on the project records, artefact and environmental assemblages to achieve the research potential of the site. A justification will be included for each analysis proposed.*

*The proposal will set out a timetable for completion of analysis and reporting, detailing all individual tasks to be completed, resources required, and the key personnel involved. The proposal will set out arrangements for monitoring of the post-excavation process, and will be provided in an Updated Project Design.*

*The report will include a synopsis of the proposed 'Full Report' and 'Publication' and identify the*

*likely destination of the publication.*

*Figures - as a minimum the assessment report will include the following figures:*

- *a site location plan tied into the Ordnance Survey at 1:1250 or in the case of larger sites at 1:2500. The plan will also include at least two National Grid points and show the site boundary;*
- *a plan at 1:1250, or a scale to be agreed with the County Archaeologist, showing the layout of the development groundworks clearly indicating the areas investigated. The plan will show significant archaeological features, coloured by phases or period as related to the development site. This plan will also include two National grid points;*
- *plans of the features revealed in each of the investigation areas at a larger scale, e.g. 1:20 or 1:50; such plans are to also illustrate areas of disturbance, change in subsoil and location of sections; the location of significant finds and samples taken will also be indicated;*
  - *relevant section drawings as appropriate;*
  - *illustrations and/or photographs of significant finds will be included where appropriate.*

*All report illustrations will be fully captioned and scale drawings will include a bar scale.*

*Standard archaeological drawing conventions will be used. Plan and section illustrations will include the numbers of all contexts illustrated. North will be included on all plans.*

*Sections will indicate the orientation of the section and the Ordnance Datum height of the section datum.*

*Photographs will be included to illustrate the archaeology of the site, the development operations or the range of soil profiles encountered. All photographs will be appropriately captioned.*

*The report will be submitted to the HET in digital format. The digital copy will be supplied in .pdf format and will contain all text, images and plans. The file will be transmitted via an internet file transfer, or, if this is not possible, via a CD-ROM formatted according to ISO 9660:1999*

**Deposition of Archive and Finds**

The finds and archive will be deposited with the Swindon Museum, as per standard conditions, and arrangements have been put in place (Accession Number: SWIMG:2022.8). Provision has been made for storage costs (at the 2022 rate), with fees based initially on two archive boxes, with additional boxes charged per item, as per museum requirements. Deposition will be undertaken within one year of the completion of fieldwork.

Digital material, including any survey files and digital photographs forming part of the primary record, will be deposited with the report and boundary file at ADS (http://archaeologydataservice.ac.uk ), accompanied by the relevant metadata. A unique number and record will be allocated to the project using the OASIS system. If further publication of the results of the evaluation is required then a specification will be agreed with LPA and costs will be provided for agreement by the client.

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South Marston

ST JULIANS
RAWLINGS CLOSE
BELL GARDENS
MAGDALENE CL
MANOR PARK
ASH GARDENS
OLD VICARAGE LANE
ROWBOROUGH LANE
ROWBOROUGH LA
A420

OH 275+KV — OH 275+KV — OH 275+KV —